

Davos Declaration · Baukultur quality system

What this tool produces · *A qualitative assessment profile of the place or project based on eight specific Baukultur criteria, identifying strengths and weaknesses to guide future design briefs.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Heritage

Spatial

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Davos Declaration · Baukultur quality system*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Shifting the focus from merely "building things" to cultivating a profound "building culture," where every brick laid is a conscious act of respect toward history, nature, and community identity.

Evidence we produce

A qualitative assessment profile of the place or project based on eight specific Baukultur criteria, identifying strengths and weaknesses to guide future design briefs.

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 to 4 weeks for full assessment and stakeholder input

Material · Davos Baukultur Quality System questionnaires, site maps, historical data

Reference case

The Swiss Federal Office of Culture initiated the Davos Baukultur Quality System to objectify the assessment of the built environment. This system has been actively used to draft guidelines for citizens' workshops, inform political decision-makers, and provide a multidimensional baseline that treats emotional and cultural criteria as equally important as economic and technical ones in spatial planning,..

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Davos · 8 Baukultur quality criteria

Duration
2 to 4 weeks for full assessment and stakeholder input

Governance good governance & participation	Functionality fit-for-purpose · adaptable	Environment climate · ecology · resources	Economy value for money · long term
Diversity mixed uses · social mix	Context place identity · landscape	Sense of place attachment · belonging	Beauty aesthetic · sensory · joyful

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.